power and not a nefarious, exploitative, near mercantile and rapacious empire bent on global domination with no respect for anyone else. Now China is seen as basically evil just about everywhere.

We are having this conversation at a time when most nations would prefer not to have a lot of Chinese people. Look what is happening in the US and Britain—the coordinated suspicion of Chinese scientists, scaring away of Chinese scientists and students. Now this intersects with another conversation—on labour shortages. This is becoming worse at a time when the Asian population is growing and while the Chinese are being rejected for geopolitical reasons and on grounds of suspicion and espionage, one still has to fill those shortages. So, boom come the young Indians, precisely when you are desperate to counter labour shortages. I went to the headquarters of SAP, the largest European software company, in Frankfurt, and what did I see? Lots of Indians. I don't remember seeing Indians in Germany during the time I was in high school. Now there is a whole city of Indians powering entire European regions.

We are accustomed to that in the US. We know Indians run the big tech companies. And this not temporary. Age, geopolitical factors, the history of Indians' presence across the world have resulted in an Indian diaspora that is embedded globally, while the Chinese diaspora remains largely in Asia. This is structural and not cyclical. The Chinese are not suddenly going to go through a cycle of learning English and assimilating. It is not a viable scenario. Can you ever envision a Chinese Satya Nadella or Parag Aggarwal? And It's not just that Indians speak English but that India is producing a huge surplus of those who study IT or medicine. These are the two largest areas of labour shortages in the whole world.

Women are another big factor. In my book, I write: "A female Indian IT professional is surely the least threatening immigrant in the world". What could you possibly find wrong with her that you don't want her in your country? She is only going to add value. She will boost your GDP, she will rent an apartment, make friends, she will never be a criminal. It may seem culturally insensitive, but it is true. The fact is that the world will embrace Indian women.

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Another factor is climate change. It will prod many Indians to relocate, initially within India and then become another reason for them to move abroad. Middle class Indians are buying property in the UAE. Recently, almost 600,000 Indians gave up their citizenship to move to other countries. When an Indian joins the middle class and can afford to move to another country, there is a good chance they will.

As a sub point, India faces a deficit of opportunities versus the number of people seeking opportunities. If you are talented and want to stay in India, there will be jobs for you in tech companies. Why should Microsoft hire someone in Seattle who is mediocre and pay him $250,000 when the same job can be done by a tech professional in India for $50,000. If you are talented, then India is not only a land of opportunity but a

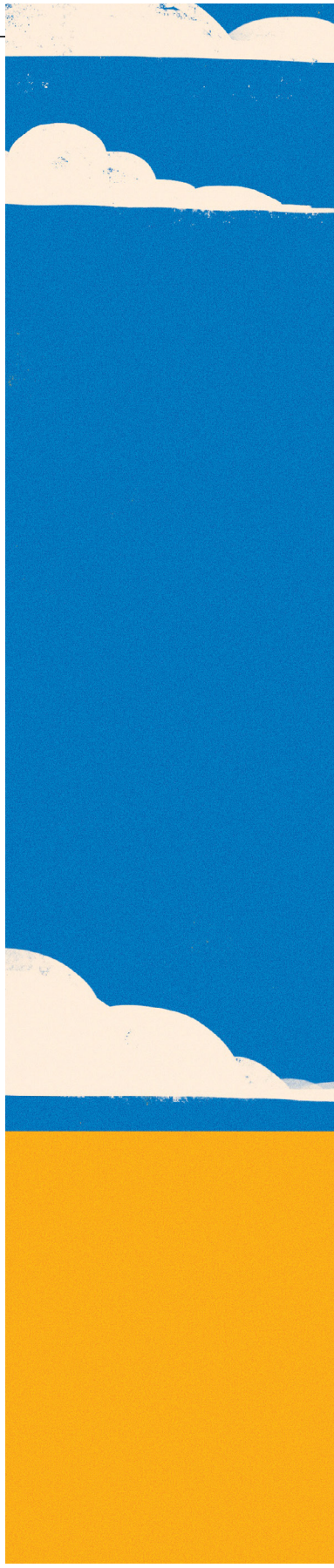


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